

TO: THE COMMONWEALTH SCHOLARSHIP COMMISSION

RE: REFERENCE FOR JOSEPH GAKUMO MUNYUI – COMMONWEALTH MASTER’S SCHOLARSHIP

Dear Members of the Commonwealth Scholarship Commission,

I am pleased to provide this reference in support of **Mr. Joseph Gakumo Munyui's** application for the Commonwealth Master’s Scholarship to pursue postgraduate studies in Cybersecurity in the United Kingdom.

I had the opportunity to mentor and work with Joseph during his time in the health information technology environment where we both worked for a USAID Funded Project – HealthIT under University of Nairobi Enterprises and Services, where I observed his professional development, technical ability, commitment to learning and approach to problem-solving. From my interactions with him, I found Joseph to be a highly motivated and intellectually curious young ICT professional who consistently demonstrated a willingness to learn, accept guidance and apply new knowledge in practical settings.

Joseph has developed a strong foundation in computer science and Information Technology. His academic background in Computer Science, complemented by his professional training in software engineering, demonstrates a clear commitment to continuous professional development. His technical interests and experience span software development, databases, Linux administration, networking, health information systems and enterprise ICT environments.

During the period I interacted with Joseph, I was particularly impressed by his ability to approach technical challenges systematically. He demonstrated good analytical and problem-solving skills and was willing to investigate issues beyond their immediate symptoms in order to understand their underlying causes. He also showed an ability to communicate technical matters to users and colleagues in a practical and understandable manner.

Joseph's professional experience has also given him exposure to environments where information security, system reliability, access control and data confidentiality are important considerations. His work supporting health information systems and later government ICT systems has exposed him to the operational realities of maintaining secure and reliable digital services. I believe this practical exposure provides an appropriate foundation for advanced study in cybersecurity.

In addition to his technical abilities, Joseph has demonstrated personal qualities that I consider important for postgraduate study and professional leadership. He is determined, receptive to feedback, adaptable and resilient. He is not afraid to ask questions when faced with unfamiliar technical challenges, and he makes a genuine effort to understand and apply what he learns. His willingness to develop himself and take on new responsibilities has been evident throughout his professional progression.

I also consider Joseph to have good leadership potential. His experience supporting users, facilitating training and working with different stakeholders has helped him develop interpersonal and communication skills alongside his technical capabilities. I believe that further postgraduate training will strengthen his ability to take on greater technical responsibility and contribute to the development of secure digital systems in Kenya.

I consider a Master's degree in Cybersecurity to be a logical progression for Joseph's career. Kenya's increasing dependence on digital government services, healthcare information systems, financial platforms and other technology-enabled services creates a growing need for professionals who can combine technical development with strong cybersecurity knowledge. Joseph's existing background in software development, ICT systems and user support provides a practical foundation upon which advanced cybersecurity expertise can be built.

I am particularly confident that Joseph will be able to apply the knowledge gained through postgraduate study beyond his own professional development. With his experience in both public-sector and health-related technology environments, he has the potential to contribute to strengthening cybersecurity awareness, secure system implementation, data protection and resilient digital infrastructure in Kenya.

Based on my experience with Joseph, I therefore highly recommend him for the Commonwealth Master's Scholarship. I believe he has the academic foundation, professional motivation, personal qualities and potential to benefit significantly from postgraduate study and to apply that knowledge constructively in Kenya.

I would be pleased to provide any further information regarding my experience with Joseph should this be required.

Yours faithfully,

Brian Owino Obewa

Software Developer / ICT Professional

Amref Health Africa

Email: brian.owino@imarishajamii.org

Tel: +254 725 122 497